Governor S.S. Ray. Ojha's response was unsympathetic: 'Rupan, these things keep happening. You are not diminished. Consider yourself lucky, it could have been worse . . .'[9] She then approached Julio Ribeiro, Gill's predecessor as director general of the Punjab Police.[10] Ribeiro was now adviser to the governor. He took note as Bajaj recounted the events of that evening. He promised to share a draft of the note with her before sending it to the governor, to enable Bajaj to confirm that it was accurate. As it happens, the report was sent to the governor the next day without the draft being shared with Bajaj.

When Bajaj met with the secretary to Governor Ray seeking an appointment with the governor, the secretary informed her that Ribeiro had already sent his report to the governor. The governor was understood to have summoned Gill and privately censured him for his conduct.[11] Governor Ray made a proposal that Bajaj considered entirely unsatisfactory: that Gill would be debarred from attending dinner parties after 8.30 p.m., and that he would apologize to her in private. Bajaj even approached the secretary in Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi's office, but this was to no avail. Until then, the media – including the journalists present at the Kapur party – had chosen to abide by unwritten norms and not report the story. A special correspondent from the *Indian Post*, a Bombay-based newspaper, decided to break the silence.[12] What was up to then known only among the elite in Chandigarh (and perhaps to some extent, in Delhi) was now disseminated across the country. A senior IAS officer had accused national hero K.P.S. Gill of sexually harassing her at a dinner party.

By then, over eleven days had passed since the party at the Kapur residence. Seeking justice through an administrative remedy had proven futile. Bajaj decided to file a police complaint. She lodged a complaint with the inspector general of the Chandigarh Police, who, as it happened, had also been at the party. In her complaint, Bajaj alleged that Gill committed several offences under the Indian Penal Code (IPC). These included crimes under Section 354 (the use of criminal force against a woman with an intention to 'outrage her modesty') and Section 509 (speech, sounds or gestures intended to insult the 'modesty of any woman'). Both offences were